towards India to deflect the new pressures it is likely to face in Asia and around the globe generally. It may view India's reluctance to condemn Russia, resisting pressures from the West, as helpful to its Russia policy. Optically, an Indian decision to attend the forthcoming BRICS summit where Putin may share the platform with Modi and Xi Jinping, would help counter the narrative of Russian isolation. China could reinforce the Indian preference for keeping its relations with Russia intact by seeking to improve bilateral relations, including through some limited easing of tensions on the India–China border. This may be the aim of the visit of Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi to India with suggestions that an exchange of more high-level visits should follow. The challenge for India would be to take advantage of these limited openings even while resisting any dilution of its commitment to the Quad and keeping its positive relationships with the US, Europe, Japan and Australia in good order. It is this network of strong partnerships that will not only help India in dealing with the China challenge but also, more importantly, enable India to build up its own economic, technological and security capabilities over time.

What are the shifts likely in the geopolitical landscape as a result of the Ukraine war and what likely impact will these have on China and on India–China relations? Do the assessments arrived at in the final chapter of this book need significant revision in the light of changed and still changing circumstances? I believe that the main conclusions retain their validity. Despite renewed Western unity and investment in hard power, it is unlikely that the long-term decline of US and Western power in general can be reversed. China is convinced that the trend lies is in its favour and that having Russia on its side enhances its relative power. It is therefore unlikely to abandon its partnership with Russia, even if a weakened Russia may become more of a liability than an asset. Be that as it may, this book has argued that despite the steady accumulation of economic, military and technological capabilities, China is unlikely to emerge as a global hegemonic power in the same league as the US, its peer competitor. The world is already moving towards a much more multipolar world, and even Asia is home to a cluster of major powers. They will, as they always have,